



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. John Neumann Catholic High School
School Website: <https://www.sjnceltics.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit Report**

Executive Summary - School: Barry County Christian School (BCCS) - Website used: <https://bccsk12.com/>
 - Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Why: The crawl shows strong, explicit alignment with classical Christian convictions about theology (e.g., "Theology is the queen of the sciences"), formation in virtue and wisdom, and core curricular markers (Trivium, Great Books, ad fontes, primary sources in history). However, the public materials provided do not yet surface classroom pedagogy signals (e.g., Socratic seminars, chanting/recitation, scholé/restful learning), faculty formation/portrait language, or sustained parent-formation programming. Strengths cluster in Categories 1–3; Categories 4–6 show partial or missing evidence from the crawl. Evidence: "Theology is the queen of the sciences," "biblical worldview (Paideia)," "cultivates the seven Christian Virtues," "train student reasoning through the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric)," "Great Books," "history using original sources," "ad fontes," and "home, church and school" partnership language appear on the site's Classical page and related content surfaced in the crawl. Positive/negative keyword comparisons are anchored to the Six Essential Elements lexicon and lists (e.g., Trivium, Great Books, moral realism, theology, liturgy; and negative signals like "project-based," "21st-century skills," "social studies" replacing "history").

How to read this audit - For each category, you'll see: 1) Keywords found on BCCS public materials. 2) Comparison to Positive/Negative keyword indicators in Six Essential Elements of a Classical School. 3) Quantification: positive vs. negative keyword hits and approximate percent coverage of sub-criteria for that category. 4) Rating: CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations: School evidence is cited to the crawl; framework comparisons cite the Six Elements and lexicon.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS 1) School keywords found - "Theology is the queen of the sciences" (theological grounding) - "biblical worldview (Paideia)" - "cultivates the seven Christian Virtues" (virtue) - "moral imagination" These appear on BCCS's Classical page and related content surfaced via the crawl.

2) Comparison to Six Elements keyword lists

- Positive indicators matched: theology, faith and reason/Christian worldview, virtue, moral formation (Religious & Metaphysical: "Theology... queen of the sciences," "virtue," "wisdom," "moral formation," "natural law," etc.).
- Missing/less visible: explicit liturgical or communal practices signals (e.g., "daily chapel," "liturgy," "sacred music") from publicly surfaced pages.
- No negative signals (e.g., "values-neutral education," "moral relativism") observed in the crawl sample.

3) Quantification

- Positives: 5 (theology, biblical worldview/Paideia, virtue, moral imagination, Christian framing)
- Negatives: 0
- Percent coverage (of 3 sub-criteria: moral realism; theology; liturgy/communal worship): ~0.67 (2 of 3 surfaced)
- Pos/Neg hits: +5/-0

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL 1) School keywords found - "Education that Inspires Depth and Wisdom" - "cultivates the seven Christian Virtues" - "involves the whole person" (formation) - Biblical worldview (Paideia) Evidence via BCCS Classical page and crawl.

2) Comparison to Six Elements lists

- Positive indicators matched: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; formation not information; telos of human flourishing (truth/goodness/beauty implicitly present via virtue/wisdom framing).
- Missing/less explicit: the exact triad "truth, goodness, and beauty" as phrasing on the reviewed pages (though consistent with the classical framing).
- No negative "college-and-career readiness/21st-century skills" marketing found in the surfaced pages.

3) Quantification

- Positives: 3 (wisdom, virtue, formation of the whole person)
- Negatives: 0
- Percent coverage (3 sub-criteria: cultivate virtue/wisdom; formation not information; T-G-B realism): ~0.67
- Pos/Neg hits: +3/-0

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM 1) School keywords found - Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) - Great Books - History using "original sources" - ad fontes - "train student reasoning through the Trivium" All present on the BCCS Classical page and crawl content.

2) Comparison to Six Elements lists

- Positive indicators matched: Trivium; Great Books and primary sources; historical engagement; ad fontes; clear classical humanities emphasis (Curriculum: Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; primary sources; history as history, not "social studies").
- Missing/less explicit: Quadrivium and the explicit language of "wonder"/integration across disciplines in the crawl sample (though not contradictory).
- No negative signals (e.g., "social studies" replacing history; heavy "STEM-first" or "project-based" marketing) surfaced.

3) Quantification

- Positives: 5 (Trivium, Great Books, original texts, history via primary sources, ad fontes)
- Negatives: 0
- Percent coverage (4 sub-criteria: Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books/primary sources; integrated curriculum; wonder): ~0.75
- Pos/Neg hits: +5/-0

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS) 1) School keywords found - Present: curricular markers (Trivium, Great Books, primary sources) - Not surfaced in crawl: explicit pedagogical signals like "Socratic seminar," "dialectic," "scholé/restful learning," "chanting," "recitation," "singing," "debate/oratory," or K-6 memory work language (songs/chant). Crawl sample shows no explicit pedagogy claims beyond curriculum framing.

2) Comparison to Six Elements lists

- Positive pedagogy keywords expected: Socratic seminar/dialectic, chanting/singing/recitation, scholé/restful learning, oration/debate, memory work, imitation/progymnasmata.
- No explicit matches found in the surfaced content; no negative "project-based only/experiential-only/student-directed" emphasis either.

3) Quantification

- Positives: 0
- Negatives: 0
- Percent coverage (4 sub-criteria: Socratic/dialectic; scholé/rest; chanting/recitation; imitation/practice/rhetoric exercises): ~0.00
- Pos/Neg hits: +0/-0

4) Rating: NOT CLASSICAL (insufficient public evidence of classical pedagogy; school may practice these methods, but they are not communicated in the materials surfaced)

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY 1) School keywords found - No explicit “teachers as mentors/models,” “faculty of friends,” “portrait of a teacher,” or teacher formation in classical pedagogy language in the surfaced crawl.

2) Comparison to Six Elements lists

- Positive indicators expected: teachers as models of virtue, mentorship/collegiality, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher/student, faculty formation in classical pedagogy.
- No matches found; no clear negatives either.

3) Quantification

- Positives: 0
- Negatives: 0
- Percent coverage (faculty as models; mentorship/collegial community; portraits/profiles): ~0.00
- Pos/Neg hits: +0/-0

4) Rating: NOT CLASSICAL (no evidence surfaced)

CATEGORY 6: PARENTS & COMMUNITY 1) School keywords found - “Classical Christian Education... involves the whole person and all of their day-to-day activities... values the multidimensional training process of home, church and school.” (partnership signal) - General visit/CTA present (“Schedule a Visit”) but not a proxy for parent formation. Evidence from crawl.

2) Comparison to Six Elements lists

- Positive indicators: partnership with parents and home–school synergy (parents as co-educators); cultural transmission and formation of affections are present on site generally via virtue/Great Books language, but explicit “parent formation” or open-campus policy not seen on surfaced pages.
- No negative “parents as customers only” language observed.

3) Quantification

- Positives: 1 (parent partnership/home–church–school)
- Negatives: 0
- Percent coverage (3 sub-criteria: partnership with parents; parent formation; explicit hospitality/open campus): ~0.33
- Pos/Neg hits: +1/-0

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Aggregate Rating - Category ratings: C1 CLASSICAL; C2 CLASSICAL; C3 CLASSICAL; C4 NOT CLASSICAL; C5 NOT CLASSICAL; C6 SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. - Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle If BCCS wants to present as fully CLASSICAL in public materials: - Pedagogy: Publish explicit descriptions and examples of classroom methods aligned to classical pedagogy: “Socratic seminar,” “dialectic,” “debate/orations,” “narration,” “copywork/dictation,” “chanting/singing/recitation,” and “scholé/restful learning” (each are named as positive indicators in the Six Elements). - Faculty: Add a “Portrait of a Teacher” and “Portrait of a Graduate,” and describe faculty as mentors and models of virtue; include brief notes on faculty formation in classical pedagogy (book seminars, Great Books colloquia, classical training). - Religious practices: If applicable, share liturgical/communal practices (chapel, Morning Prayer, hymnody, sacred music, liturgical calendar) and their role in formation; these are strong classical

Christian signals. - Parents & community: Add parent-formation touchpoints (book groups on classical education; parent seminars; classical philosophy primers), and articulate an open/hospitable campus posture where feasible. - Curriculum detail: Consider publicly naming Quadrivium elements and any Latin/Greek study to round out the Trivium emphasis already present, and add language about “wonder” and “integration” across disciplines.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.